



Ready4EIC application • August 2026

The social play platform that turns “who wants to play?” into a trusted match.

FIND • GATHER • PLAY

A live Progressive Web App for sport, board games, pub games and gaming — connecting players and venues across Serbia, with a path to the Western Balkans and the EU.

Serbia • EU enlargement

Local hub: STP Belgrade

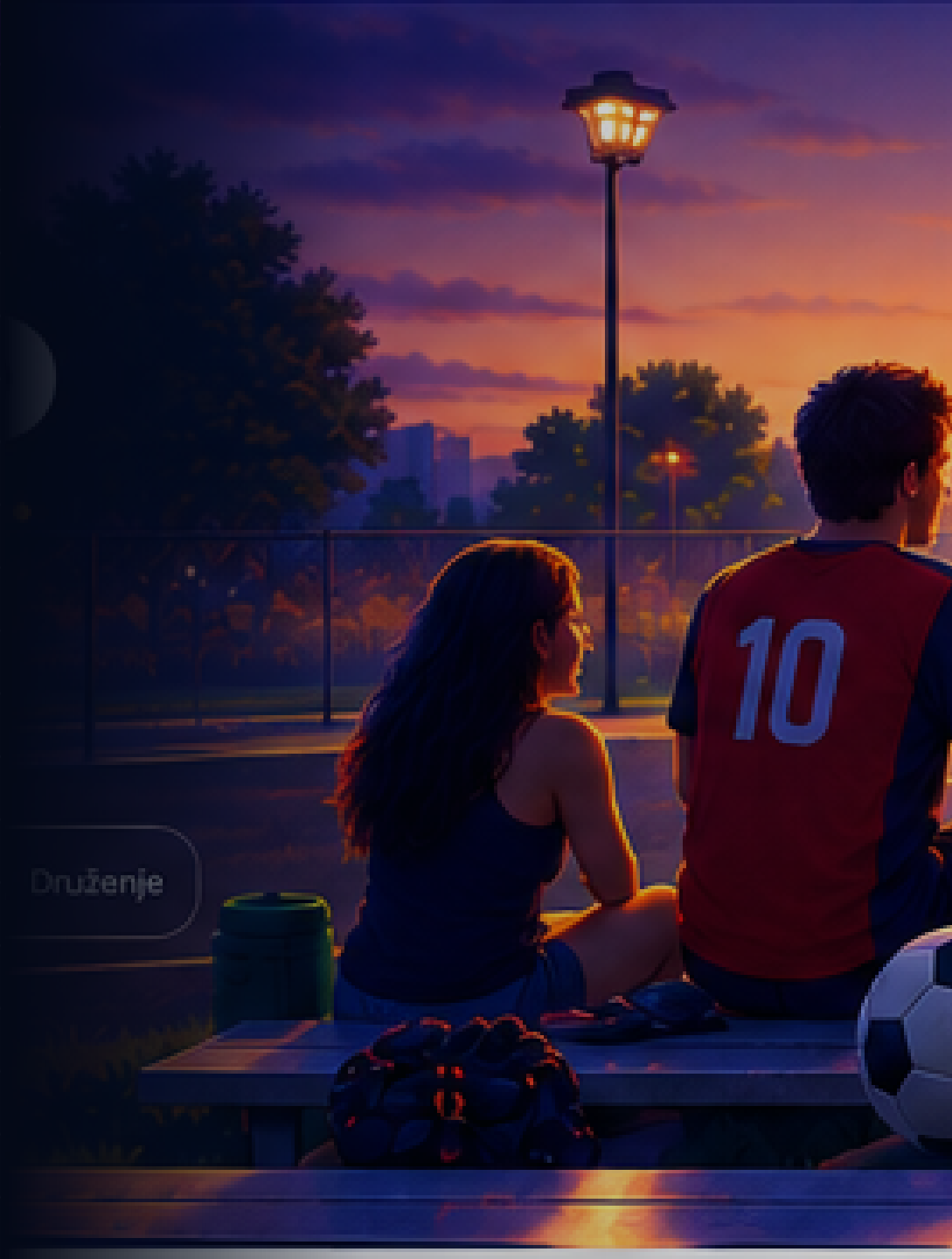
Digital marketplace

Confidential

Prepared for Ready4EIC — Accessing funding and enabling growth

European Commission programme for innovative SMEs in enlargement countries

Druženje



COMPANY SNAPSHOT

An innovative digital service, ready to professionalise growth.

We are applying for Round 1 capacity-building — then Round 2 investment readiness and European funding pathways (Horizon Europe / EIC).

PWA

Live product: map, matches, courts, push, ratings, chat

2-sided

Players + court owners in one marketplace

4

Play categories: sport, tabletop, pub, gaming

RS → WB

Serbia first, then Western Balkans & enlargement

What we are

Founder-led digital startup from Serbia. Brand: **Plejko**. Born from a real gap: wanting a football game abroad and finding neither the pitch nor the people. Now a location-based play network with a trust layer and venue tools for sports SMEs.

Stage

Product-ready (software TRL 6–7). Pre-scale go-to-market. Seeking structured growth planning, unit economics, investor engagement and a realistic EU funding route — not a grant today, a preparation programme.

The ask

Accept Plejko into Ready4EIC Round 1 with Innovation Advisors at **Science Technology Park Belgrade**. Ambition: qualify for Round 2 (scaling & investment readiness).

THE PROBLEM · FOUNDER INSIGHT

I wanted a game. I had **no pitch** and **no people**.

On holiday in another country I wanted to play football — and could find neither the fields nor anyone to play with. Locals fail the same way every week, in closed WhatsApp groups. Venues stay empty. Newcomers never get invited.

1. Coordination failure

Finding enough players at the right hour is social friction, not a sports problem. Groups die in chat threads. Newcomers never get invited.

2. Empty courts, analogue SMEs

Small sports venues (the backbone of amateur sport) have no digital booking, no community feed, no show-up data. Demand is invisible.

3. No-shows destroy supply

Without reputation, cancellations are free. Organisers stop hosting. The marketplace never reaches critical mass.

4. Tools are too narrow

Playtomic = racket booking. Meetup = generic events. Instagram = discovery without operations. Nothing is built for Balkan pickup culture across sport + games.

That holiday moment is not a tourist anecdote — it is the product. The same gap hits travelers, students, diaspora and locals. Across enlargement countries, play is still unbundled into private chats: a mobility, health and SME-digitalisation problem.

THE SOLUTION

Plejko: find people, gather a match, play.

One installable web app. Map-first discovery. Formal venues and informal meetups. Trust, payments split, chat and ratings after the game.

01

Pronađi — Find

See nearby matches and fields on a live map. Filter by preferred games. Get push when something opens in your radius.

02

Okupi — Gather

Create or join. Waitlist if full. Court approval for registered venues. Cost splitter. Quick chat. Reliability stays visible.

03

Igraj — Play

Show up. Complete the match. Rate teammates (skill + fair play). Trust score updates. Come back next week.



Sport

Football, basketball, padel, running...



Board games

Catan, chess, UNO, D&D...



Pub games

Darts, billiards, bowling, quiz...



Gaming

FIFA, LoL, CS2, Valorant...

PRODUCT

Two roles. One network effect.

Players**Social play, with consequences that are fair**

- Map + list of open matches; geo push in a chosen radius
- Formal (registered field) and informal (pin on the map) matches
- Join / waitlist / cancel-attendance with reliability impact
- Match chat, cost splitter (RSD), post-match ratings
- Trust badge from reliability score (0–100)
- OAuth (Google / Facebook) + cookie-based secure session

Court owners · local SMEs**Digital operations for venues**

- Create and manage fields, sports, price, working hours
- Approve / reject / complete match reservations
- Reserve empty slots; occupancy becomes visible
- Player community that returns — not one-off Instagram DMs
- Pathway to paid listing, commission and venue SaaS

Stack (built, not mocked): React + TypeScript PWA · Node/Express · MongoDB · Socket.IO real-time · Web Push · Cloudinary · deployed on Render (EU/Frankfurt). Installable on home screen — no app-store gate for first markets.

INNOVATION

Not another sports listing. A **trust protocol** for real-world play.

Ready4EIC scope: innovative product + business model. We are digital / social-tech, not deep-tech hardware — honest positioning, high regional relevance.

Trust as infrastructure

Reliability score, timed cancellation penalties, no-show marking, fair-play ratings. This is the missing layer that WhatsApp cannot provide — and the reason two-sided marketplaces usually stall.

Dual-mode supply

Registered courts (approval workflow, overlap control, deadlines) plus informal pins (parks, homes, pubs). Captures both the SME venue economy and grassroots pickup culture.

Multi-category identity

One profile across football, Catan, darts and FIFA. Cross-category liquidity is a business-model innovation: evening board-game players become weekend teammates.

PWA for enlargement markets

No store tax, instant updates, Web Push, works on mid-range Android first. Designed for Serbia and replicable across AL, BA, ME, MK, XK, TR, MD, GE, UA.

MARKET

Serbia is the beachhead. Enlargement is the region.

Same culture of pickup sport, café games and late-night squads — fragmented digital tools. We scale language-by-language, city-by-city.

~6.6M

Serbia population. First GTM: Belgrade, Novi Sad, Niš. Target: digitally active 18–40 who already organise play in chats.

~18M

Western Balkans. Shared product-market fit; Ready4EIC sister hubs in AL, BA, ME, MK, XK are a distribution channel, not just mentoring.

EU next

Diaspora cities + recreational-sport digitalisation (Playtomic proved racket booking). Plejko aims at community liquidity, not only court checkout.

Where money sits

Players pay for pitch time, equipment, drinks. Venues lose yield on empty hours. Brands want authentic local sport audiences. The platform sits between all three — starting with venue digitalisation (B2B) and network density (B2C free).

Why now

PWA + push is mature. Post-covid social rebuild is incomplete. Court sports (padel, small-sided football) are investing in facilities. Young users will not download a 12th native app — they will add an icon if the match is tonight.

BUSINESS MODEL

Free liquidity. Paid infrastructure.

Players grow the graph. Venues and promotions pay for yield. Ready4EIC workstream: turn this logic into a financial model, pricing tests and an investor narrative.

Now — grow

Free for players. Court owners list fields.
Goal: density in 1–2 cities. Cost splitter
already in-product (offline payment mark-
off).

B2B venues

Subscription for field management,
featured placement, reservation tools.
Optional commission on confirmed
bookings once volume exists.

Promotions

Sports brands, pubs, board-game cafés:
sponsored matches, featured events, local
campaigns to a geo-qualified audience.

Later — premium

Organiser tools, verified identity,
tournament mode, white-label for clubs /
municipalities. Open to EU public-sport
partnerships.

Unit-economics hypothesis (to be stress-tested in the programme): one active court SME + recurring weekly matches can justify a software fee far below a no-show's lost slot. Network value compounds; CAC should stay low via geo-push and share-links rather than paid UA in year one.

COMPETITION

We do not out-padel Playtomic. We out-community WhatsApp.

	PICKUP + TRUST	VENUE OPS	MULTI-CATEGORY	LOCAL LANGUAGE / BALKANS	NO-SHOW COST
Plejko	Yes	Yes	Sport + games + pub + e-sport	Serbian-first	Reliability score
WhatsApp / IG	Closed groups	No	Ad hoc	Native	None
Playtomic	Booking-led	Strong (rackets)	Narrow sports	EU, not RS-native community	Cancellation policy
Meetup / FB events	Events, not matches	No court workflow	Broad	Generic	RSVP theatre

Defensibility: local supply (courts + informal spots) + reputation graph + category breadth. Data on who actually shows up is the asset. We treat Playtomic as a signal that venue digitalisation funds, not as a clone target.

STATUS & ROADMAP

Built. Now we must become a company that scales.

No vanity user metrics in this deck. The product exists; the growth system, funding story and regional GTM do not yet — that is exactly why Ready4EIC fits.

Already in production

- Full match lifecycle: create, join, waitlist, complete, rate
- Court owner console: fields, approvals, reservations
- Informal matches with map pin + deadline rules
- PWA install, Web Push, real-time match rooms
- Trust / reliability engine; block list; cost splitter; chat
- sr-RS UI, EU hosting (Frankfurt)

12-month product & GTM (draft — to be challenged by advisors)

Q1: 1–2 city density + 20–40 partner venues. Q2: payments / invoicing experiments, organiser tools. Q3: Montenegro / BiH language pack + hub intros. Q4: investor materials + Horizon/EIC call mapping.

Gaps we admit

- Formal financial model & cap table hygiene
- Measured traction dashboard for investors
- Legal entity / IP / ToS hardening for EU scale
- Sales motion for court SMEs
- English product layer for enlargement
- Clear “EIC or not EIC” decision

These gaps are the curriculum, not a reason to wait.

WHY READY4EIC

We need advisors before we need a cheque.

Programme fit: innovative digital service from Serbia, seeking funding readiness, investor engagement, and a serious look at Horizon Europe / EIC — delivered with STP Belgrade.

Round 1 — what we will use immediately

- 1** Innovation & growth plan: city-by-city GTM, venue sales script, KPI tree (liquidity, show-up rate, venue NRR).
- 2** Tools inside the company: simple financial model, pricing experiments, data room skeleton.
- 3** 1:1 with STP Belgrade Innovation Advisors: legal/IP checklist, positioning vs. “deep-tech” calls we should not force-fit.
- 4** Investor-facing story: problem, unfair advantage, 18-month milestones — practised, not improvised.

Round 2 ambition — if selected

- A** Investment readiness: term-sheet literacy, raise/no-raise decision, intro path via the hub network.
- B** European funding map: which HE/EIC/cascade instruments actually match a marketplace PWA (and which do not).
- C** Regional scale design using Ready4EIC hubs: BA, ME, MK, AL, XK as launch partners, not just slides.
- D** If deep-tech funding is not the right box, leave with a cleaner alternative (EIC Accelerator later only if tech depth warrants it).

NEXT STEP

Let people in enlargement countries **find a game tonight.**

Plejko is already software. Ready4EIC is how we become a fundable, scalable company — with STP Belgrade as the local innovation hub.

Vision

The default way to gather a match in the Western Balkans — then a European social-play layer that makes empty courts and lonely evenings rarer.

Decision we ask

Admit Plejko to Ready4EIC Round 1 (online via Webex, from September 2026). Assign Innovation Advisors at Science Technology Park Belgrade.

Contact

Brand: **Plejko**
Country: Serbia
Hub: STP Belgrade
Tagline: Pronađi · Okupi · Igraj

Legal name, founder and email: as submitted in the EUSurvey form.

**Ajde na Plejko.**

Find · Gather · Play · More than a game. People. Matches. Good stories.